

Mona Schirmer

PhD Candidate in Machine Learning

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PhD student working on safe and robust ML, with a focus on measuring and improving alignment of generative models to human preferences.

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate in Machine Learning AMLab, University of Amsterdam ◦ Supervisor: Eric Nalisnick ◦ Thesis topic: Safe and Robust Machine Learning in Dynamic Settings	2022 - present Amsterdam
M.Sc. Statistics Technical & Humboldt University Berlin	2019-2021 Berlin
Diplôme d'Ingénieur Statisticien Économiste (M.Sc.+B.Sc.) ENSAE Paris	2017-2019 Paris
B.Sc. Economics Humboldt University of Berlin	2015-2019 Berlin
B.A. Political Science University of Munich	2011-2015 Munich

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Applied Science Intern Amazon ◦ Project: Aligning Generative Retrieval Models with Human Preferences	June - Nov 2025 Berlin
Research Assistant The World Bank ◦ Supervisor: Sam Fraiberger ◦ Project: ImpactAI - Extracting Evidence for Development Economics (link)	2022 - 2024 remote
Research Intern Bosch Center for AI ◦ Supervisor: Maja Rudolph ◦ Project: Modeling Irregularly-Sampled Time Series	Apr - Sep 2021 remote
Research Intern Information Systems Chair, Humboldt University of Berlin ◦ Supervisor: Stefan Lessmann, Alona Zharova ◦ Project: Probabilistic Topic Extraction from Scientific Text	Jul - Aug 2018 Berlin

PUBLICATIONS

FAccT	Schirmer, M. , Thielmann, A., Schwöbel, P., Martynec, T., Di Benedetto, G., London, B., Stein, Y. (2026) Aligning Recommendations with User Popularity Preferences. <i>ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency</i>
Preprint	Sauter, A., Schirmer* , M. (2026) Between Rules and Reality: On the Context Sensitivity of LLM Moral Judgment. <i>preprint</i>
NeurIPS	Schirmer* , M., Jazbec*, M., Naesseth, C., Nalisnick, E. (2025) Monitoring Risks in Test-time Adaptation. <i>Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems</i> . Oral at PUT@ICML workshop (Top 8% of accepted papers)
TMLR	Schirmer, M. , Zhang, D., Nalisnick, E. (2025) Temporal Test-Time Adaptation with State-Space Models. <i>Transactions on Machine Learning Research</i> . Journal-to-Conference Certification (Top 10 % of accepted papers)
DistShift@NeurIPS	Schirmer, M. , Zhang, D., Nalisnick, E. (2023) Beyond Top-1 Agreement: Using Divergences to Forecast Performance under Distribution Shift. <i>NeurIPS 2023 Workshop on Distribution Shifts</i> .
EMNLP Findings	Lasri, K., Quinta de Castro, P., Schirmer, M. , San Martin, L., Wang, L., Dulka, T., Naushan, H., Pougué-Biyong, J., Legovini, A., Fraiberger, S. (2023) EconBERTa: Towards Robust Extraction of Named Entities in Economics. <i>EMNLP Findings</i> .
ICML	Schirmer, M. , Eltayeb, M., Lessmann, S., Rudolph, M. (2022) Modeling Irregular Time Series with Continuous Recurrent Units. <i>International Conference on Machine Learning</i> .

MISCELLANEOUS

Grants & Awards	Hackathon Winner (video link), Paris Peace Forum (2018) Travel grants, several institutes (2013, 2017, 2018, 2019) High School Scholarship, Roland Berger Foundation (2009-2011)
Reviewing	ICML 2023, 2024, 2025 NeurIPS 2023, 2024, 2025
Teaching	Supervisor of M.Sc Thesis: Moral Beliefs Encoded in LLMs Supervisor of M.Sc Thesis: Hyperspherical Online Learning TA for Deep Learning II (Graduate, 2025) TA for Machine Learning I (Graduate, 2023) TA for Introduction to Machine Learning (Undergraduate, 2022)
Professional Experience	Student Assistant Data Science @ Idalab Consulting, Berlin (2020-2021) Intern NLP @ OECD, Paris (2019) Project Student Machine Learning @ Deloitte, Paris (2019) Project Student Machine Learning @ Canal+, Paris (2018-2019) Student Assistant @ Chair of Statistics Humboldt Uni., Berlin (2016-17) Student Assistant @ German Public Broadcaster ARD, Munich (2012-2015)